

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Chris O'Dea

Address: 44 York Road Cheam SM2 6HH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Any proposal for the site should be brought forward in a respectful, sensible and above all safe manner.

The proposed change of use raises significant concerns relating to traffic, parking availability, congestion and pedestrian safety, particularly given the proximity of the local school and the narrow residential streets surrounding the site.

The plans do not appear to take into account the impact on residents, school staff, parents, children or bus services at peak times. Many parents and young children use these roads daily, and with the potential for increased vehicle numbers - especially at times when children finish early or walk with preschool siblings - the risk of accidents would increase.

As a resident of York Road, I am very familiar with the congestion already present during school pickup and dropoff times, especially in the roads being suggested for parking. The two bus routes serving the area already become delayed or blocked due to traffic, and any increase in vehicles would worsen both congestion and pollution.

This raises a fundamental question: can the site be converted while accommodating the additional traffic it would generate at peak times, without causing unacceptable risks to pedestrian and road safety? Based on current evidence, this does not appear to be the case.

This is not an emotional argument, but one rooted in public safety - particularly the safety of school children. If there is any uncertainty about the extent of the risk, the council should undertake a

public traffic and highwaysafety study to properly assess it.

If the site were to be converted in a way that significantly increases traffic, substantial mitigation would be required, such as dedicated onsite parking (potentially including underground provision) and appropriate trafficflow controls to prevent large numbers of vehicles entering or exiting simultaneously. Additional parking restrictions or a residents' permit scheme would also be needed to protect the surrounding streets from overflow.

In its current form, and due to the unresolved questions and challenges outlined above, the proposal should be rejected unless and until these issues are fully addressed and satisfactorily resolved.